Singapore, and a working-level dialogue, before Australia withdrew in 2008. In 2017, the dialogue on the Indo–Pacific was restarted and the four met again in 2018 at a working level. This was upgraded initially to a foreign ministers' dialogue and in 2021 a leaders' level summit. While the four countries do military exercises—specifically, the Malabar naval exercise— much of their activities have been security adjacent. That is, they are led by the foreign or other ministries, but have indirect implications for security. The Quad's structure has been a suite of working groups, initially three on health, climate, and technology cooperation that subsequently proliferated to a large number that encompassed infrastructure, cyber security, maritime cooperation, space, and science and technology. [43] In part, the structure is intended to produce outcomes without the unnecessary bureaucracy of a secretariat. The Quad's issue set is meant to provide public goods in the Indo–Pacific that presents a viable alternative to China without exacerbating security competition, a concern of many partners in Southeast Asia and elsewhere. Still, the scope for broadening and widening the Quad's objectives—even if on a limited basis or set of issues—remains considerable.

Indian security partnerships to preserve a favourable balance in the Indo–Pacific should not be relegated to the states of the Indian Ocean, ASEAN, and the Quad. European states—and in particular France and Britain—retain a major footprint in the Indo–Pacific. France has significant maritime territory in the southwest Indian Ocean and in the South Pacific, and resident populations there. It also has military facilities in Djibouti and the United Arab Emirates. The UK also has military assets in West Asia and South-east Asia. India has recognized their role, including through a logistics supply agreement with France. European Union member states such as Germany and the Netherlands and EU institutions have also been articulating Indo–Pacific strategies. Other Pacific countries, including South Korea and Taiwan, hold promise for defence, intelligence, and technological relations. South Korea has long had an active commercial relationship with India but is increasingly cooperating with India on defence and security. Taiwan's status is complex, but economic and